LEAN CANVAS

Project: MindCare AI | Domain: SDG 3 (Good Health & Well-being) | IBM SkillsBuild - AICTE - BharatCares 2026

1. PROBLEM

Top 3 Problems

- Severe shortage of mental health professionals in India (0.75 per 100,000 population).
- Heavy social stigma & fear of judgment preventing youth from seeking early help.
- High cost of professional therapy sessions (₹1,500 - ₹3,000/hr) and financial barriers for students.
- Late diagnosis: distress escalates to clinical depression or crisis unnoticed.

4. SOLUTION

Top 3 Features

- 24/7 empathetic conversational AI with active listening & CBT-informed check-ins.
- Deep NLP-driven Early Distress Detection (DistilBERT: Normal, Stress, Anxiety, Depression).
- Clinically-grounded emotion triage
- Privacy-by-design & zero data leakage
- Longitudinal Mood & Distress Severity Tracking.

3. UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION

Single, Clear, Compelling Message

"An always-accessible, stigma-free AI wellness companion that accurately detects subtle emotional distress, delivers empathetic support, and bridges users to professional help.

- Instantaneous crisis detection guardrails
- Culturally contextualized for Indian youth

9. UNFAIR ADVANTAGE

Cannot be easily bought or copied

- Fine-tuned Hybrid DistilBERT + BiLSTM model trained on verified clinical distress corpora.
- Proprietary Safety Guardrail & Suicide Intent Fallback Protocol.
- Seamless API bridge to national Tele-MANAS & KIRAN helplines.
- Dual privacy encryption (DPDP Act 2023 compliant).

2. CUSTOMER SEGMENTS

Target Users

- College students & young professionals (18-28 yrs) experiencing academic/career burnout
- Tier-2 and Tier-3 city youth lacking local mental health infrastructure.
- University counseling departments needing automated triaging.
- Healthcare CSR initiatives seeking scalable impact.

EXISTING ALTERNATIVES

- In-person clinical therapy (costly, stigmatized)
- Static helpline phone numbers (often busy, unengaged)
- Generic chatbots (lack clinical distress triage & safety)

HIGH-LEVEL CONCEPT

"Triage Nurse + Empathetic Companion in your pocket" - Duolingo-like streak engagement meets Clinical First Aid.

EARLY ADOPTERS

- Engineering & college students facing exam stress and job placement anxiety.
- Tech interns & remote workers feeling isolated.
- Anonymous online community members.

8. KEY METRICS

Key Performance Indicators

- Active Daily/Monthly Users (DAU/MAU)
- NLP Distress Classification F1-Score (>94%)
- Average Session Length & Retention Rate
- Crisis Escalation Response Time (< 2.5 sec)
- User Self-Reported Relief Index (1-5)

5. CHANNELS

Path to Customers

- University & College Student Wellness Portals
- IBM SkillsBuild & CSRBOX Community Outreach
- Mobile Progressive Web App (PWA) / WhatsApp Bot
- Mental Health NGOs & Campus Counseling Centers

7. COST STRUCTURE

Fixed and Variable Costs

- Cloud Hosting & GPU Inference Servers (Hugging Face / AWS EC2 / Azure) : 35%
- Model Training, Fine-Tuning & Data Annotation Pipeline : 25%
- Domain, Security, SSL, and DPDP Compliance Audits : 15%
- Clinical Advisory Board, Psychological Validation & Content Updates : 15%
- Maintenance, Developer Ops & Monitoring : 10%

6. REVENUE / SUSTAINABILITY STREAMS

Monetization & Impact Models

- B2B Institutional SaaS Subscriptions (Colleges, Universities, EdTech Platforms).
- Corporate CSR Sponsorships & Healthcare Grants (CSRBOX, CSR foundations).
- Freemium Model (Free unlimited AI triage & screening; Premium licensed 1-on-1 therapist booking).
- White-label Wellness API licensing for enterprise employee assistance programs (EAP).